

other people understand. That's a natural fallout of it. The money, also, will flow in. But it is not as simple as it sounds. I dubbed *RRR* into five languages. Why didn't I dub it into Gujarati, Rajasthani or Bengali, if dubbing itself is going to get you money? It's not so easy. There is a way to communicate with people, that I'm not coming in your language and that communication takes a huge amount of time and money. So, then you judge which is the best way to do it, and go forward. After *Baahubali*, it's not rocket science to understand that *RRR* will find traction in markets like Uttar Pradesh, for example.

the story and making it in multiple languages.

If I'm making a bigger story, and I'm making a pan-India film itself, the economics [of making a remake] doesn't work. When I'm making a big film across the country, someone taking the same story and doing it in a different language again doesn't make any sense.

smaller films have done well in cinemas.

When you go to the cinema, you are going to watch the film with a large number of people but there is some kind of connect. You are all together in that three-hour journey. There are films that provide that kind of a combined entertainment [experience] for

I keep that completely separate. Professionally, I am different. I don't try to rub my thoughts on to my characters, or on to my storytelling. So, when I start writing a story, for me, it is the emotion I should be moved by. I might be agnostic, but when I see a good film, like for example, *Annamayya*, a Telugu film which is

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Does Hindi-dubbed versions doing well mean that there's not as much space for Telugu and Tamil remakes?

It depends on what kind of film you're making. If the film-maker in South, for example, feels his story has a pan-India kind of an appeal, then he will make it on the dynamics of a pan-India film. So obviously, there is no chance of a remake. But if I find a story that is very compelling, and we feel that it is a regional film, then we make it in our own languages.

A story like *Maryada Ramanna*, for example, I will only make in Telugu because I loved that story. If it's a smaller story, I'm okay with someone taking



After the advent of OTTs, is there a distinction that massy, big-ticket films will go to the theatres while high-concept films will be reserved for OTTs?

A bit of yes, and a bit of no. There will be classification of films which tilt more towards OTT and films which tilt towards the big cinemas. Or, in other words, there will be films which the audience would want to watch in the cinemas, and those they would prefer to watch on a personal device. But the classification is not big spectacle versus high concept. Even

those 200-400 people. OTT would not give you the same experience. And, there are some films where you're just connected with the content on the screen. Those kind of films, people would prefer to watch on OTTs. That's my take on it, my assumption. I don't know whether I'm right, or wrong.

You've spoken about being an agnostic person, but your films have mythological themes. How do you decide on your themes?

My personal opinions, my thoughts, and my lifestyle have nothing to do with my profession.

about a devotee of Lord Venkateshwara, and when I see the climax, I cry. It is a conversation between God and the man, his disciple. I might not believe in God, but I connect to the emotion of a devotee and a God. And, I connect to the emotion that drives masses: devotion and submission to a greater self.

I understand the power of that emotion, the power of a mass emotion, and I too feel that emotion. I might not believe in God, but I believe in the emotion, and if it moves me, I write it. **BT**

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